Thomas Kramer

Brand and Product Designer

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SUMMARY

Brand and product designer (BFA, Graphic Design) who carries identity and campaign systems into tokenized, WCAG AA product UI. Designs in Figma and Adobe CC; builds in Framer and React with Claude Code (2 live web apps shipped in 2026).

EXPERIENCE

TAKramer Designs — Charlotte, NC
Brand and Product Designer (Freelance) — Jan 2021 - Present

- Designed brand identities, logo systems, and guidelines for 5+ clients in apparel, faith-based organizations, and social media, applied across 50+ print and digital assets
- Refreshed a church's logo and designed, specified, and sourced its apparel line from concept to delivery: $4,000+ in revenue from dozens of orders
- Designed every slide and post for a weekly Instagram series for nearly a year, with a content framework and Meta Ads budget; reach and engagement grew steadily into an active community

University Recreation, UNC Charlotte — Charlotte, NC
Graphic Designer — Aug 2023 - May 2024

- Led visual direction for 2 week-long campus campaigns (5 themed days with 5 partner departments; 5 programmed events) reaching ~36,000 people and 250,000+ impressions across print, digital signage, social, and web
- Managed a 50+ page Drupal CMS website (content accuracy, brand consistency, information architecture) and wrote SOPs and handoff docs for a student staff with yearly turnover

M28 Charlotte Campus Ministry — Charlotte, NC
Graphic Designer — Sep 2021 - May 2023

- Designed infographics, campaigns, and event advertising that earned 80,000+ impressions each semester
- Applied UX writing to promotional material and coordinated committee deliverables; event attendance rose campus-wide

PROJECTS

Grace One Church: Website Redesign | takramerdesigns.com/projects/grace-one-church — Aug 2025 - Present

- Redesigned a client church's 16-page site in Figma and Framer at 3 breakpoints (1440/810/390px) around first-time visitors; merged feedback from 5 stakeholders into one change table
- Ran 14 audit rounds (UX, WCAG, SEO); the baseline logged 19 P0/P1 issues, including 1.66:1 contrast, up to 7 H1s per page, 12px mobile body text, and ~200 images without alt text
- Specified the fix as a design system (8-point spacing replacing 11 ad hoc values, 44px touch targets, 16px body floor)

Nydex: Trading Workstation Web App | takramerdesigns.com/projects/nydex — Mar 2026 - Present

- Designed and shipped a live trading web app solo (React, Supabase) with a Cmd+K keyboard model and 300+ tests
- Built a token-based design system with no UI framework and zero layout shift
- Fixed all 3 P1 issues from a Nielsen heuristic review (27/40); moved a 650ms scan off the main thread to a Web Worker

Underline: SEC Earnings Brief Web App | takramerdesigns.com/projects/underline — Jul 2026 - Present

- Designed and shipped a web app that turns SEC 10-Q and 10-K filings into research briefs; cut data loading from 9 API calls to 1 (~450ms cold, ~75ms warm)
- Specified a check of every figure against its source filing, with measured data labeled apart from AI text: blocking errors fell from 61 to 0 across 12 test briefs
- Designed light and dark themes with an automated WCAG AA contrast check on every text and surface pair; raised the heuristic score from 31/40 to 34/40

SKILLS

Brand and Visual: Brand Identity, Logo Design, Brand Guidelines, Typography, Layout, Art Direction, Campaign Design, Copywriting, Print Production, Packaging, Motion Graphics

Product and UX: UI/UX, Design Systems, Design Tokens, Prototyping, Information Architecture, Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA)

Tools and Code: Figma, Adobe Creative Cloud (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, After Effects, Premiere Pro), Framer, Webflow, Drupal, HTML, CSS, React, Supabase, Vercel, Git, Claude Code, Cursor

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Charlotte — Charlotte, NC
Bachelor of Fine Arts, Graphic Design | Dean's List, 5 semesters — Dec 2025

Central Piedmont Community College — Charlotte, NC
Business and Finance Coursework — Aug 2026 - Dec 2026

License: Securities Industry Essentials (SIE), FINRA — Jun 2026

Certification: Anthropic Academy, Claude Code and AI Fluency — May 2026